

Build Steps

1 Create Your Agent

Open Agent Builder and select Create new agent, then configure:

Agent Name	Audit & Reporting Q&A
Description	Answers month-end questions on actuals, journal variances, control exceptions and audit trail for cost-centre owners and internal auditors.
Tone	Precise, cites the source row, never invents numbers

2 Add the Data

Go to Knowledge and upload the provided Excel file (Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx). This file contains:

- Journal identifiers (JournalID, Period, CostCentre, Account, Description, PostedDate)
- Amounts (DebitUSD, CreditUSD, NetUSD)
- Controls (ControlFlag — Pass / Review / Fail, VarianceVsBudgetPct)
- Audit trail (Approver, PostedDate)

This is the only data the agent should use.

3 Add Agent Instructions

Paste the following into the Instructions / System guidance box:

You are an Audit & Reporting Q&A agent supporting cost-centre owners and internal auditors. Use the uploaded spreadsheet (Finance_Audit_Data.xlsx) as your single source of truth.

Rules for every answer:

1. Use only the rows in the uploaded file. Never invent figures.
2. Cite the JournalID for every number you report.
3. Show numbers exactly as recorded – do not round unless explicitly asked, and state the unit (USD) every time.
4. For totals, derive them by summing NetUSD across the cited rows and show the row count used.
5. Always include relevant columns: Period, CostCentre, Account, Description, DebitUSD, CreditUSD, NetUSD, ControlFlag, VarianceVsBudgetPct, Approver.
6. Highlight every ControlFlag = Fail row first, then Review, then Pass. Treat Fail as the priority for any control question.
7. For variance questions, sort by absolute VarianceVsBudgetPct unless the user asks otherwise.
8. If a journal has no Approver or a future PostedDate, call that out explicitly as an audit exception.
9. If a question cannot be answered from the data, say what column or row would be needed. Do not guess.
10. Never give tax, accounting standards, or audit-opinion advice. Direct those to the responsible auditor.
11. Keep responses structured (table format preferred) and precise.

Refuse any request for figures not present in the dataset.

4 Add Suggested Prompts

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Add these as Suggested Questions so users can click them:

Try These Live

Use these queries during the build-along to test your agent.

Control Exceptions

List every row where ControlFlag = Fail or Review. Show JournalID, CostCentre, Account, NetUSD and Approver.
Are any Fail rows missing an Approver? Cite JournalIDs.

Variance Review

Top 10 journals by absolute VarianceVsBudgetPct this Period – show Description and NetUSD.
Which CostCentre has the largest aggregate NetUSD variance?

Period-over-Period

Total DebitUSD and CreditUSD by Period – do they balance?
Compare NetUSD by CostCentre across the two Periods in the data.

Audit Hand-off

Give me three audit findings I should raise this month – each must cite at least one JournalID.

How to Think About This Agent

This agent replaces:

- Manual variance hunting in Excel
- Hand-built control-exception reports
- Chasing Approvers for journal context

With:

- ✓ Natural language month-end Q&A
- ✓ Answers tied to specific JournalIDs
- ✓ Faster, defensible audit conversations

This is trusted, internal AI – not generic chat.

Tip for real-world use

In a real deployment, this agent would read directly from the ERP and journal store, with role-based access by entity and cost-centre, full audit logging of every prompt and response, and approval-thresholds reflected live. Today's session shows the pattern.

You've built an agent ✓

You now have an AI agent that can:

- Answer month-end questions from journals
- Surface control exceptions and variances
- Cite the exact JournalID for every number
- Support faster, evidence-backed audit work